

task to offer a competitive price.

The cost of a connector can be directly affected by the pricing of raw materials used for its production. The commodities such as copper, gold, silver, tin, plastic and resins used in connectors are generally following an increasing price trend. Due to their rise in price, and such factors as exchange rate, the connector manufacturers find it highly challenging to hold the price of connectors at existing levels or try for minimal price increase, year on year.

Solutions being implemented

Since connector manufacturers find it difficult to hold the prices down, there is a constant endeavour to explore newer materials and new manufacturing techniques to remain competitive. They also try and match product lifecycles to constantly support their customers in terms of technology and market dynamics. It has been noticed that the customers are ready to invest greatly in high-end, innovative, customised interconnection

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solutions that are not high volume.

There are instances where the price levels have gone a little down for certain types of connectors. This happened because of the increase in the number of users, in accordance with the theory of economies of scale.

The major lookouts for this industry are basically the opportunities for the growth of infrastructure and electronics. More and better infrastructure will require more electrical connections along with an increase in the number of terminals and connectors to be used.

Similar is the requirement of the elec-

tronics industry. It requires rapid deployment of the policies all across along with the setting up of the manufacturing and design clusters for electronics systems, including better infrastructure.

Once the clusters are developed they need testing and verification facilities, which require availability of proper R&D centres for a high growth potential. It is also essential to ensure that the institutes start focussing on the market and the latest products to understand the upcoming technologies and their implementations. ●

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